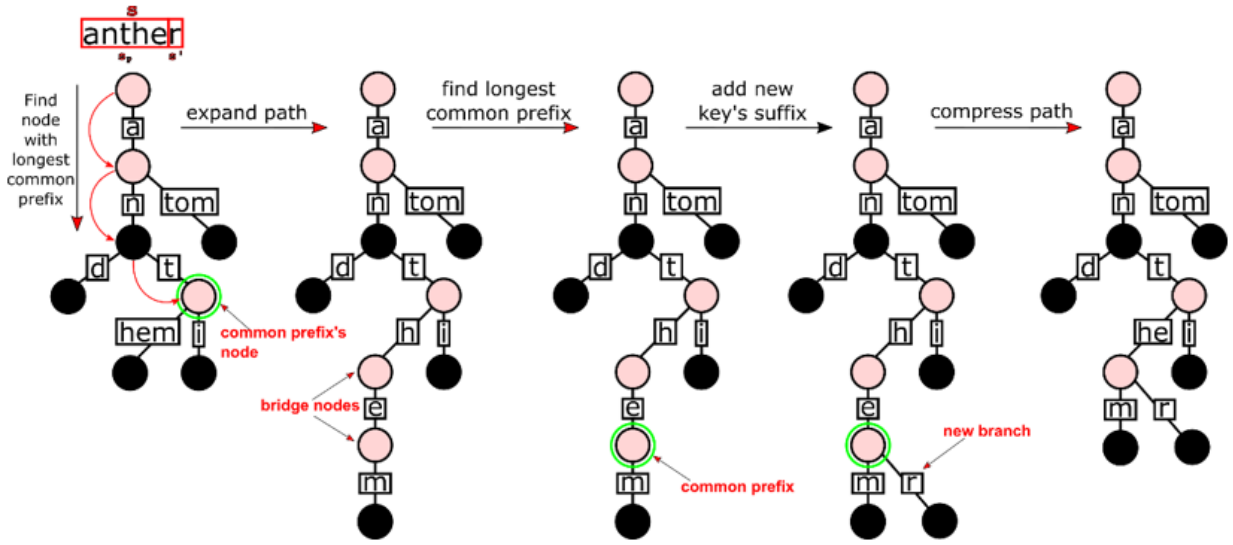


Figure 6.19 Another example of method insert with path decompression explained step by step.

Traversing the tree becomes more complicated, because at each node we need to distinguish between the 4 different possible results of the edge label matching, and this complexity is reflected in the length of the method; moreover, when we bump into case #2 or #3, we need to break down an edge and add a bridge node. Adding a new branch, however, becomes easier, because we just need to add a new edge and a single node.

6.3.4 Remove

Like for search, the only changes to the remove method, with respect to tries, revolve around the extraction of the common prefix. This is not surprising, since deleting a key can be thought as a successful search followed by a clean-up of the deleted node.